

Ken Stager

AI Systems Architect

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Enterprise AI systems architect working at the platform layer. Owns the architecture of Praxo, Digital Realty's production AI platform on Azure, and of the governed gateway that brokers the organization's AI models to internal engineering teams. Contracted concurrently by Microsoft as an AI Architect to carry an internal agent from beta to full production. Builds the evaluation and rollout machinery that decides whether a change ships: harnesses, shadow-mode comparison, feature flags, and go/no-go readiness assessments.

Core: LLM systems engineering · multi-agent orchestration · RAG and hybrid retrieval · evaluation harnesses · shadow-mode comparison · Azure OpenAI · Python

EXPERIENCE

AI Solutions Architect

Digital Realty Trust, Inc. | June 2025 – Present

- Sole AI Solutions Architect for Praxo, an enterprise AI platform on Azure, in production and rolled out to **~4,000 employees**. Microsoft 365 integration for mail, calendar, and files runs on an on-behalf-of flow.
- Tasked by leadership to create the AI API Developer Portal, a governed gateway brokering the organization's AI models to internal engineering teams; lead architect, live in production. Approval-gated provisioning, one-time encrypted key delivery, on-demand rotation, and per-subscription token metering with cost showback, under least-privilege roles where provisioners cannot read keys.
- Architected the multi-agent retrieval layer running in production: parallel domain agents across 5 domains orchestrated in Semantic Kernel, pgvector-backed vector search merged with Reciprocal Rank Fusion (RRF), and a prompt composer. Rebuilt its routing architecture in a measured optimization program that raised routing accuracy from 69% to **95%** on a 170-question golden benchmark, eliminated retrieval errors, and cut pipeline latency 74%; shipped dark behind feature flags and verified live in production.
- Traded a measured +7% end-to-end latency for an **18%** cut in response-generation time, where users actually feel it; parallelizing router classification gave back an observed 500–1,500 ms per query.
- Present architecture at review boards and review code across most of the department. Led a platform security audit and remediation program.
- Built the reliability scaffolding the platform depends on: **3,000+ automated tests**, shadow-mode comparison, and feature-flagged rollout.

AI Architect (Contract)

Microsoft Corporation | April 2026 – July 2026

- Carried an internal AI agent from beta to full production: beta flag removed, streaming rolled out to production.
- Originated and built the agent's evaluation platform end to end: harnesses exercising the real published agent through the full production path, independent quality instruments whose deltas had to agree, a statistics layer, and a cost model.
- Authored the go/no-go readiness assessment behind the production rollout, using paired tests, false-discovery control, and explicit practical-significance thresholds.

AI Solutions Architect (Independent Consulting)

Self-employed | November 2023 – June 2025

- Delivered AI-driven scheduling automation for a healthcare organization under NDA, reducing operational backlog without adding staff while maintaining HIPAA-aligned data handling.
- Implemented OCR-based document processing with Amazon Textract, turning unstructured healthcare forms into structured data for downstream workflows.
- Built an end-to-end news analytics pipeline for near-real-time triage: discovery, extraction, clustering, and deduplication.

Customer Success Manager

BlueConic, Inc. | February 2022 – November 2023

- Onboarded enterprise customers on a Customer Data Platform (CDP), translating complex data models into practical enablement.
- Advised global clients on first-party data strategy and privacy compliance, including GDPR and CCPA.

Owner and Business Manager

Penn360 | August 2016 – December 2021

- Founded and ran an architectural photography and marketing-media business serving architects, designers, and realtors; owned client contracts, operations, and finances, and led a team of three.

SKILLS

AI Systems: LLM systems engineering, multi-agent orchestration, agent routing, intent classification, guardrails, structured outputs, Azure OpenAI, Semantic Kernel

Retrieval: Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), hybrid retrieval, vector search, embedding models (text-embedding-3-large), Reciprocal Rank Fusion (RRF), GraphRAG, context compression, entity resolution, pgvector

Reliability & Evaluation: evaluation harnesses, shadow-mode comparison, safe rollout, feature flags, regression testing, observability, structured logging, schema validation, pytest

Cloud & Platform: Azure Functions, Azure Container Apps, Azure Cognitive Search, Azure Cosmos DB, Azure Blob Storage, Azure AD, AWS (Amazon Textract), Infrastructure as Code (Bicep), PostgreSQL, Docker, Azure DevOps

Languages & Frameworks: Python, TypeScript, SQL, FastAPI

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Columbia Engineering, Columbia University | 2024

Applied Artificial Intelligence Program

Coursework: supervised and unsupervised machine learning, predictive modeling, time-series forecasting, natural language processing, transformer architectures, applied AI development, AI and data ethics.